

CHAPTER 1 – CAUSE / EFFECT ESSAY

1.2. WHAT IS A CAUSE/EFFECT ESSAY?

Exercise: Read the writing prompts below. In groups, try to come up with as many reasons/results as you can to answer the questions. You will present your reasons and results to the rest of the class.

1. What are the reasons for learning a second language?

- to impress people around you,
- to develop confidence
- to increase your brain power
- to transform your travel experience
- to improve your employability
- to study or live overseas
- to become more open-minded
- to discover a new culture

2. Why do people have mobile phones?

- quick way of communication,
- chance to talk and text people without having to meet them,
- wide range of cell phone plans from cheap to expensive,
- wide range of services

3. Why do we feel so stressed, even though we have so much technology?

- lives in a constant rush majorly caused by advancing technologies.
- not feeling satisfied,
- creating needs rather than solving problems, etc.
- physical effects on human health

4. What are the effects of being a workaholic?

- very stressful,
- decreasing the productivity level of the brain,
- missing out on the rest parts of life,
- can be an addiction
- not participating in one's own life,
- physical effects on human body

5. What are the consequences of having a big family?

- sharing power is developed at high level
- learns social as well as family backgrounds
- child becomes dull because of excessive of love from all the family members
- parents cannot be strict on many things
- the child often remains poor in studies, etc.

6. How does global warming affect people's lives?

- extreme heat,
- natural disasters,
- poor air quality,
- allergens and other nuisances,
- spreading diseases,
- resources at risk

7. What are the positive effects of reading books?

- mental stimulation,
- stress reduction,
- knowledge,
- vocabulary expansion,
- memory improvement,
- stronger analytical thinking skills,
- improved focus and concentration,
- better writing skills

1.3. BRAINSTORMING AND MAKING AN OUTLINE

B) Read the paragraphs A - D below for the essay "*The Effects of a Positive Outlook on Our Lives*". The paragraphs are not in the correct order. Working with a partner, number the paragraphs 1 to 4 in the best order.

The Effects of a Positive Outlook on Our Lives

1 (C) Happiness is a state of being that everyone wants to achieve. There are many different ways of becoming a happy person. A positive outlook, which is one of the many ways of reaching a state of happiness, can help you be happy and change the outcome of your life. A positive outlook can enrich your relationships and guide you through some of life's greatest challenges.

2 (D) A positive outlook helps you find happiness in professional and social relationships. Having a positive attitude will help you find a good job and keep it. Colleagues enjoy working with someone who always looks on the bright side and avoids conflict. Your positive attitude towards your work and colleagues will enhance your relationships with them. Another benefit of approaching your relationships positively is that friends will appreciate your energy and want to spend more time with you. A happy person makes everybody else happy as happiness is contagious. As a consequence, any partnership will be a solid, strong and happy relationship with the help of a positive outlook.

3 (A) People with a positive outlook are stronger and more capable of confronting difficult situations. They develop clear minds, which help them cope with life's challenges better than those individuals who are not at peace with themselves. Happy people's optimism creates the strength needed to find rational solutions to the many unexpected problems that life presents. Another reason why they can easily handle challenges is this optimism also promotes their self-confidence and self-esteem. For example, happier students are more likely to approach professors for help when they are having some trouble with their course work. They also do not hesitate to take risks since they believe in their potential and they are not afraid of making mistakes. In contrast, unhappy or less happy students may internalize their frustration and be less likely to seek out help.

4 (B) In conclusion, happiness will bring us strong relationships, the ability to face any obstacle and the opportunity to achieve our goals. It is a good idea to have a positive outlook and recognize what makes us happy since it will bring us more harmony. If we promise ourselves to laugh more and think positively, we will change our lives for the better.

I. INTRODUCTION:

Thesis Statement: *A positive outlook can enrich your relationships, guide you through some of life's greatest challenges and help you achieve your goals.*

II. BODY PARAGRAPH 1:

Topic Sentence: A positive outlook helps you find happiness in professional and social relationships.

Support 1: It helps you find a good job and keep it

Support 2: *It also has a beneficial effect on social relationships.*

III. BODY PARAGRAPH 2:

Topic Sentence: *People with a positive outlook are stronger and capable of confronting difficult situations.*

Support 1: They develop clear minds, which help them cope with life's challenges

Support 2: They can easily handle challenges is this optimism also promotes their self-confidence and self-esteem.

IV. CONCLUSION:

Paraphrasing the Thesis Statement: *In conclusion, happiness will bring us strong relationships, the ability to face any obstacle and the opportunity to achieve their goals.*

Final comment: If we promise ourselves to laugh more and think positively, we will change our lives for the better.

2. WRITING CAUSE/EFFECT ESSAYS

2.1. INTRODUCTION PARAGRAPH

Exercise - Read the following sample introductions and identify the prompt and the method or methods (funnel approach – from general to specific details, defining important words, or reverse cause and effect) used in each one.

1. Cancer is a leading cause of death worldwide. It kills more people in one year than all criminal and accidental deaths combined. Even though most people overcome the disease, they have to take on an immense financial burden to pay their hospital fees. Additionally, they have to struggle with physical side effects as well as emotional distress. Research shows different types of cancer might be caused by different factors, yet the main causes can be divided into environment and genetics.

Prompt: What are the causes of cancer? _____

Method(s): Funnel Approach, Reverse Cause and Effect _____

2. Any person who has lived in the twentieth century has seen a lot of changes take place in almost all areas of human existence. Some people are excited by the challenges that these changes offer. However, those who consider the negative effects of these changes want to return to the simpler lifestyle of the past. The two undesirable effects of the changes brought by the twentieth century are a polluted environment and the depersonalization of human relationships.

Prompt: What are the effects of the changes brought by the 20th century? _____

Method(s): Funnel Approach _____

2.3. WRITING BODY PARAGRAPHS FOR CAUSE/EFFECT ESSAYS

1. **Organization:** Each body paragraph should start with a **topic sentence** that states the main idea of the paragraph and has **supporting details** related to the topic sentence. All the sentences should follow a logical pattern.

Exercise:

Read the thesis statements and write topic sentences for body paragraphs.

1. Global warming is caused by two major factors: man-made factors and natural factors.

a. One of the major factors that causes global warming is man-made factors.

b. Natural factors are another important factor that causes global warming.

2. Some women delay having children since they want to accomplish career objectives and do not want to limit themselves in their social lives.

a. Career objectives is one of the major reasons why women delay having children.

b. Another reason why women delay having children is that they do not want to limit themselves in their social lives.

2. Development (Writing Supporting Sentences)

A) Analyze the mind map about the causes of migration. Read the following paragraph and develop the second supporting idea with your own facts, details or examples.

The prompt: "What are the causes of migration?"

BODY 1:

Unfortunately, devastating wars are a common occurrence causing large groups of people to emigrate. Wars create an unsafe environment for people and many families emigrate to escape the danger. Recently the war in Syria has caused a large number of families to move to Turkey. These refugees did not want to leave their homes but the dangerous fighting has forced them to move to a safe place where they are protected from the devastation. The war in Syria is just one example of people migrating for safety, unfortunately there are, and have been many other situations like this. Furthermore, wars destroy the natural environment. **The application of weapons, the destruction of structures and oil fields, fires, military transport movements and chemical spraying are all examples of the destroying impact war may have on the environment. Air, water and soil are polluted, man and animal are killed, and numerous health affects occur among those still living.** People who rely on the environment for their way of life are forced to leave these areas. They must migrate to new areas of the world where they can continue their existence.

3. LANGUAGE TIPS

Rewrite the following sentences using hedging language to make them more cautious.

1. The cloud will change the weather patterns.
There may well be a change in weather patterns if the cloud is introduced.
2. The machine will use too much CO₂ in the building process.
It appears that the machine will use too much CO₂ in the building process.
3. The project to encourage sea life will create problems with international law.
There may be problems with the project to encourage sea life regarding international law.
4. Building CO₂ storage plants will be too expensive.
It appears that building CO₂ storage plants will be too expensive.
5. There will be problems with releasing the CO₂ back into the atmosphere.
There may well be a problem with releasing the CO₂ back into the atmosphere.

4. STRUCTURE & VOCABULARY AIDS FOR CAUSE/EFFECT ESSAYS EXERCISES

1. Fill in the blanks with one of the connectives.

(More than one option is possible)

due to	as	as a result	thus	on account of	since
for this reason		therefore	because		consequently

1. Schools for girls were built. **As a result**, girls had a chance to learn about health and life skills.
2. **Because** girls learned about health skills, they improved the sanitation of their villages.
3. Girls were given school uniforms **since** they needed to feel that they were a valued part of the school.
4. The girls felt proud to have a uniform. **Consequently**, they were more likely to attend school every day.
5. The family members of the girls walked them to school **as** they didn't want other males in the village to taunt the girls.
6. After graduation, the girls were more likely to start small businesses **on account of** their mathematical and accounting skills.
7. Some graduates became valued business owners. **Thus**, they were invited to serve on business councils.
8. **On account of** their community status, they were able to vote on improving water and sanitation.
9. Health conditions improved in villages. **Consequently**, more babies and children survived.

2. Look at the chart and match the phrases in the two columns. Then identify which phrases are the causes and which phrases are the effects of a situation. Put them into sentences using the verbs in parenthesis.

1. Smoking (cause)	A sense of responsibility and a feeling of compassion (effect) -3
2. A wide range of job opportunities (effect)	Cultural differences (cause) -4
3. Caring for animals (cause)	Premature aging (effect) -1
4. Misunderstandings (effect)	Poor management (cause) -7
5. A desire for attention (cause)	Networking (cause) -2
6. Unemployment (cause)	Bullying behavior (effect) -5
7. Business failure (effect)	An increase in crime rates (effect) -6

- Smoking results in premature aging. (result in)
- Networking leads to a wide range of job opportunities. (lead to)
- Caring for animals brings about a sense of responsibility and a feeling of compassion. (bring about)
- Misunderstandings result from cultural differences. (result from)
- Bullying behavior is caused by a desire for attention. (to be caused by)
- Unemployment gives rise to an increase in crime rates. (give rise to)
- Business stems from poor management. (stem from)

3. Rewrite the following sentences using the cause and effect linkers in parenthesis.

- He has a busy schedule; **therefore**, he won't be able to see us until Friday. (Due to)
Due to having a busy schedule, he won't be able to see us until Friday.
- One consequence of** unemployment is the increase in crime rates. (bring about)
Unemployment brings about an increase in crime rates.
- Being innovative in business **results in** gaining more customers. (Lead to)
Being innovative in business leads to gaining more customers.
- In America, many banks went bankrupt **as a consequence of** the economic crisis. (result of)
In America, many banks went bankrupt as a result of the economic crisis.
- As** a lot of well-known companies require at least three years of work experience, graduates from university start their careers in small companies. (Consequently,)
A lot of well-known companies require at least three years of work experience. Consequently, graduates from university start their careers in small companies.

6. Poor cultural literacy levels can **stem from** too much technology. (result in)

___ **Too much technology can result in poor cultural literacy levels.** ___

7. Not finding time to relax is **a cause of** the fast pace of life nowadays. (because of)

___ **Not finding time to relax is because of the fast pace of life nowadays./ Because of the fast pace of life nowadays, people cannot find time to relax.** ___

4. Combine the prompts given below using cause/effect linkers. Use a different linker in each sentence.

1. **cause:** being a member of a social club

effect: taking more responsibilities

One consequence of being a member of a social club is taking more responsibilities.

Taking more responsibilities can be a result of being a member of a social club.

2. **cause:** cultural differences

effect: communication breakdown

Behavioral differences between employees of different cultures can cause communication breakdown.

Communication breakdown can stem from cultural differences between employees / people.

3. **cause:** financial problems

effect: unhappy marriage

Financial problems can (expectedly / eventually) result in unhappy marriages.

Financial problems may bring about / give rise to unhappy marriages.

4. **cause:** lack of study skills

effect: failure at school exams

When / If a student lacks study skills, (then) his / her chance of failure at school exams rises.

The cause of / the reason for failure at school exams can be lack of study skills.

5. **cause:** use of technology in class

effect: variety of activities and materials

One consequence of use of technology in class is the variety of activities and materials.

Use of technology in class leads to a variety of activities and materials.

6. **cause:** being workaholic

effect: variety of activities and materials

Being a workaholic can result in / cause serious health problems.

Serious health problems can be one consequence of being a workaholic.

7. **cause:** consuming fattening food

effect: gaining weight

An increase in fattening food consumption gives rise to / leads to gaining weight.

One consequence of gaining weight is consuming fattening food.

5. Error Correction: Find if the sentences are correct or incorrect by focusing on the meaning. Write 'C' if correct and 'I' if incorrect.

_I_1. Example: Because workers are under so much pressure to produce results in a higher level of stress.

_C_2. Example: Another related cause of stress is the need to earn money to survive in our more and more commercial world.

_C_3. Applying different methods of communication results in a better society.

_I_4. Being multilingual ~~causes~~ **derives from** having parents speaking different languages.

_I_5. A damage in relationships ~~gives rise to~~ **results from** overuse of social media.

_C_6. Demolishing old houses to build modern ones has led to high concerns by preservationists.

_I_7. Having a part time job as a student can be caused by poor academic scores.

Poor academic scores can be caused by having a part time job as a student.

_I_8. Human workforce poses a threat to advances in the field of artificial intelligence.

Advances in the field of artificial intelligence poses a threat to human workforce.

_C_9. Oppositions to same sex marriages derive mostly from a conventional way of thinking.

_C_10. Having educated parents affects the upbringing of children in a positive way.

6. Complete the blanks either with a verb or a connective

There is no doubt that we have to live with far more noise than in the past, particularly in cities and this may be the form of pollution which affects us directly. For example, it has been found that prolonged exposure to high levels of noise can 1 **_cause_** hearing loss and high blood pressure. It may also 2 **_lead to/produce_** stress, insomnia and mental problems, including depression. These problems, in return, often 3 **_bring about_** lower productivity at work. 4 **_One consequence is that_** employees are too tired and stressed to work efficiently. In order to find effective solutions to the problem, it is necessary to understand what has 5 **_given rise to_** this increase in noise. There are 3 main reasons why there has been an increase in noise. Firstly, there is traffic noise, which is 6 **_caused by_** the ever-increasing number of vehicles on our roads. The second major source of noise in our cities is low-flying aircraft which have either just taken off or are just landing at local airports. Finally, noise can also 7 **_be a consequence of_** neighbors listening to music or watching television or using noisy power tools such as drills or lawn movers. To sum up, measures should be taken to reduce the amount of the noise in our daily lives.

SAMPLE ESSAY – What are the causes of stress?

Stress can be regarded as one of the most widespread problems that the people of the 21st century have to face. Due to stress, people's lives turn upside down and they feel desperate most of the time, but why do a lot of people feel stressed? The causes of stress have been studied by a lot of researchers and the results of these studies demonstrate that there are various reasons. **The two main reasons for stress are difficulties of living in a big city and poor working conditions.**

One of the most significant causes of stress is that people living in big cities encounter some serious adversities. **First and foremost**, the traffic in big cities is so heavy that people are affected negatively by it because of the time they waste on the road and being exposed to aggressive drivers, which leads to stress. To illustrate, an individual wasting hours every day to commute can find time neither for socializing nor for relaxation. Consequently, many people who have to live in big cities are stressed. **Moreover**, since big cities are usually crowded there are usually a lot of people wherever one goes. As a result, the noise pollution and not being able to find a spot where people can relax brings about stress. In other words, when people want to spend some time to relax outdoors, all they get is more stress due to many people and their noise. **In brief**, living in a big city is the main cause of stress not only because of heavy traffic but also due to the high number of people living in cities.

The difficult working conditions are the other cause of stress. **First of all**, people have to work hard to earn enough to afford the necessities for themselves and their families. In many workplaces today, employees are asked to work too hard for the profit of the companies. Some people even work overtime to get their work done. Consequently, the hard work not only takes away from the precious time they need to spend with their families but also makes them exhausted which leads to stress. **In addition to the hard working conditions**, nowadays, it is difficult to get and keep a job on account of the limited employment opportunities provided by governments in a lot of countries. Therefore, a lot of people fear losing their jobs, which makes them stressed out because their life standards will be constrained if they stay unemployed for a long time. **All in all**, tough working conditions are the most significant cause of stress in people's lives.

To sum up, difficulties of living in a big city and the hard working conditions are some of the significant causes of stress. Today, big cities are crowded and working conditions are not easy in many jobs, and there are a lot of people suffering from the ultimate consequence of these conditions, which is stress. My point of view is that whatever the conditions are, for a happy and a healthy life, people should do their best to manage the level of their stress.